CHECKLIST

How To Make Data-Driven Decisions with Clio

Tracking the right metrics is crucial for law firms aiming for sustainable growth, increased profitability, and operational excellence. This resource provides practical, actionable insights into essential metrics you can measure across Clio*, empowering your firm to become more data-driven, productive, efficient, and profitable.

**Ability to access the linked reports will depend on your Clio user permissions, subscription plan level and products subscribed to on your account. To speak to your account representative about making changes to your account, send us a message through the general inquiry form.*

Clio

Pillar: Financial Performance & Trends					
Metric	**Relevance**	**How to Measure in Clio***	**How to Calculate**	**Frequency**	**Benchmark**
Revenue Per Lawyer *Revenue earned per practicing lawyer*	Productivity and profitability per lawyer	• Clio Manage Revenue Report • Productivity by User Report • Help article	Total Revenue ÷ Number of Practicing Lawyers	Monthly	—
Realization Rate *% of billable hours invoiced*	Indicates efficiency in billing process	• Clio Manage Firm Dashboard (filter by % for MoM) • Help article (See section: Side Bar Navigation | Dashboard)	(Billed Hours – Discounted Hours) ÷ Billable Hours Worked) × 100	Monthly	Avg. Rate: 86%†
Realization Lockup *Days of revenue unbilled (work-in-progress lockup)*	Indicates billing efficiency and cash flow impact	*See page 6 for calculation instructions using* Clio Manage Work in Progress (WIP) Report ÷ Billing History Report Amount × 365 days	(WIP ÷ Previous FY Collections) × 365	Monthly	Median: 47 days†
Collection rate *% of invoiced work that gets paid*	Indicates collections efficiency	• Clio Manage Firm Dashboard (filter by % for MoM) • Help article (See section: Side Bar Navigation | Dashboard)	Total Hours Collected ÷ Total Non-discounted Hours Billed	Monthly	Avg. Rate: 91%†
Collection Lockup *Days of revenue uncollected (debtor lockup)*	Reflects collection efficiency and cash flow health	*See page 6 for calculation instructions using* Clio Manage Accounts Receivable Report ÷ Billing History Report Amount × 365 days	(A/R ÷ Previous FY Collections) × 365	Monthly	Median: 27 days†
Total Lockup *Combined days of unbilled and uncollected revenue*	Overall indicator of cash flow and liquidity	Sum of Realization Lockup and Collection Lockup	Realization Lockup + Collection Lockup	Monthly	Median: 92 days†

† Data as reported on in the Legal Trends Report.

Pillar: Financial Performance & Trends					
Metric	**Relevance**	**How to Measure in Clio***	**How to Calculate**	**Frequency**	**Benchmark**
Revenue Growth Trend *Monthly or quarterly revenue performance comparison*	Measures growth trajectory and financial health	• Clio Manage Revenue Report • Help article	(Current Period Revenue – Previous Period Revenue) ÷ Previous Period × 100	Monthly/ Quarterly	—
Monthly Incoming Matter Volume *Count of new matters opened in a given month*	Baseline indicator of firm growth and demand	• Clio Grow Matters Added Report • Help article	Total count of new matters within selected date range	Monthly	—
Seasonal Matter Volume Trend *Month-to-month or quarter-over-quarter matter volume comparison*	Identifies seasonal fluctuations in matter volume to inform planning needs	• Clio Grow Matters Added Report (filter by Date Range) • Help article	Current Month Volume vs. Same Month Last Year	Quarterly	—
Matter Volume to Revenue Lag Indicator *Correlation between new matters and future revenue*	Forecasts revenue shifts based on intake volume	Compare Clio Grow Matters Added Report with Clio Manage Revenue Report	% Change in Intake Month 1 vs. % Change in Revenue Month 2 and 3	Quarterly	—
Referral Volume & Conversion Rate *Total referrals and the % that convert to clients*	Helps identify your best referral sources by volume—and more importantly, quality	• Clio Grow Referral Report (filter by First Touch Source = Referral) • Help article	(Hired Referrals ÷ Total Referrals) × 100	Monthly/ Quarterly	—

Pillar: Operational Efficiency					
Metric	**Relevance**	**How to Measure in Clio***	**How to Calculate**	**Frequency**	**Benchmark**
Utilization Rate *% of lawyer's day spent on billable tasks*	Highlights efficiency and productivity of a law firm. The higher the rate, the more time spent on billable work.	• Clio Manage Firm Dashboard (filter by % for MoM) • Help article (Section: Side Bar Navigation | Dashboard)	(Billable Hours ÷ Available Working Hours per Day) × 100	Monthly	Avg. Rate: 37%†
Lockup Days *Days to bill and collect payments*	Shortening the time between work performed and payment collected improves cash flow.	• Clio Manage Work in Progress Report • Accounts Receivable Report • Help Article	(WIP + A/R) ÷ Prior Year Collections × 365	Monthly	Median: 97 days†
Task Completion Rate *% of tasks completed on schedule*	Efficiency in task management	• Clio Manage (Advanced Plan Only) Task Productivity by User Report • Help article	Tasks Completed on Time ÷ Total Assigned Tasks × 100	Weekly	—
Intake Conversion Rate *% of potential new client converted to paying clients*	Efficiency of intake processes defined by your win rate of new clients	• Clio Grow Matters Added Dashboard | See Conversion Rate (Apply Filter: Date Range) • Help article	(Hired Clients ÷ Total Potential New Client Inquiries) × 100	Monthly	—
Most Profitable Matter Types *Matter types with highest revenue per case*	Helps prioritize profitable case types	• Clio Grow Matter Revenue Report • Clio Manage Matter Revenue Report • Productivity by Client Report	Total Revenue by Matter Type ÷ Number of Matters of that Type	Quarterly	—
Matter Type Distribution *% of total matters per type*	Helps evaluate practice focus and alignment	Clio Grow Matters Added Report (filter by Matter Type)	(Matters per Type ÷ Total Matters) × 100	Quarterly	—

† Data as reported on in the Legal Trends Report.

Pillar: Productivity					
Metric	**Relevance**	**How to Measure in Clio***	**How to Calculate**	**Frequency**	**Benchmark**
Casework Volume *Number of active cases per lawyer*	Indicates workload management	Clio Manage Matter Productivity by User	Total Open Matters per Lawyer	Weekly	—
Billable vs. Non-Billable Hours *Ratio of billable to non-billable hours*	Measures time efficiency across admin vs. legal work	Clio Manage Client Activity Report or Realization Report by User	Total Billable Hours ÷ Total Non-Billable Hours	Monthly	—
Average Case Duration *Average time from opening to closing cases*	Reflects case and time management efficiency	—	Sum of Case Durations ÷ Number of Closed Cases	Quarterly	—
Online Payment Adoption Rate *% of clients using online payments*	Indicates collections efficiency and client convenience	—	Number of Clients Using Online Payment Methods ÷ Total Number of Clients × 100	Monthly	—

Steps for Calculating Lockup in Clio

01. In Clio Manage, go to Reports

02. Select Accounts Receivable Report

- Set parameters to all clients, all responsible attorneys, all practice areas
- Set the time frame to your last billing period, i.e. last month
- Run the report
- Record the **Accounts Receivable Total**

03. Select Work in Progress Report

- Set parameters to all clients, all responsible attorneys, all practice areas
- Set the time frame to your last billing period, i.e. last month
- Run the report
- Record the **Work in Progress Total**

04. Select the Billing History

- Set parameters to all clients, all responsible attorneys, all practice areas
- Set the time frame to Last Year (Jan to Dec)
- Run the report
- Under Grand Totals, record the **Amount**

05. Use the formulas for Realization Lockup, Collection Lockup, and Total Lockup in the table

TURNING METRICS INTO ACTION

How to Optimize Firm Performance

To improve performance, your firm needs a clear understanding of its key metrics. Use the firm metrics table provided in this resource to calculate the KPIs listed below and establish your benchmark values. These metrics allow you to track progress and make informed decisions about where to optimize operations, marketing, and productivity over time. Where applicable, we've included insights on how to improve these metrics—based on real-world data from the Legal Trends Report and Clio opt-in product usage insights.

Clio

Financial Performance

REALIZATION RATE

Include in quarterly billing performance reviews with all relevant stakeholders.

Spot inefficiencies in billing practices and reduce unnecessary write-downs. Firms using Clio's outstanding balances reminders—to follow up with unpaid bills—and bulk billing had realization rates that were 26% and 21% higher, respectively, than firms that did not use these features. Refer to industry benchmarks to see how your firm stacks up against others your size.

COLLECTION RATE

Make this part of your regular monthly financial review.

Examine aged receivables and client-specific trends to improve follow-up and payment consistency. Firms using Clio's email bill sharing had 3% higher collection rates, and among all firms that used automated bill reminders, **49% more** revenue was collected per lawyer each month vs. firms that did not. Refer to industry benchmarks to see how your firm stacks up against others your size.

EXPENSES RATIO

Evaluate quarterly with relevant stakeholders.

Use this metric to guide investment decisions, cost-cutting, or hiring decisions when margins tighten.

MONTHLY INCOMING MATTER VOLUME

Review monthly for marketing planning.

Set month-over-month targets and identify which channels or campaigns are driving volume.

SEASONAL MATTER VOLUME TREND

Review quarterly for operations planning.

Use seasonal patterns to plan staffing or promotional efforts during predictable peaks and lulls.

MATTER VOLUME TO REVENUE LAG INDICATOR

Review quarterly.

Correlate new matter spikes with revenue projections to better forecast cash flow and marketing ROI.

REVENUE GROWTH TREND

Review monthly for finance planning.

Compare performance to prior periods and tie back to client types, practice areas, or marketing efforts that contributed most.

REFERRAL VOLUME & CONVERSION RATE

Review monthly for marketing and client development planning.

Spot your top-referring sources that lead to new clients and double down on nurturing those high-value relationships.

Operational Efficiency

UTILIZATION RATE

Review weekly with relevant stakeholders.

Set minimum targets and assess time management to improve billable performance. Low utilization might suggest distractions, poor task management, or unclear priorities. Use Clio Duo to assist with document review and task prioritization, freeing up more time to focus on client work. Refer to industry benchmarks to see how your firm stacks up against others your size.

LOCKUP DAYS

Review monthly for financial operations planning.

Use baseline to experiment with quicker billing workflows in Clio Manage (e.g. using automated bill reminders, bill themes, bill message templates) and encourage online payment to improve cash flow. Law firms accepting online payments reduce total lockup by four days.

TASK COMPLETION RATE

Review in weekly team standups or assistant check-ins.

Flag overdue work with individuals and highlight task management in performance reviews to encourage operational discipline.

INTAKE CONVERSION RATE

Review monthly with relevant stakeholders.

Diagnose drop-off points in your intake process to unlock bottlenecks and apply consistent processes to improve conversions. Consider automating time-intensive tasks like scheduling, reminders, and intake with a tool like Clio Grow—firms that do have seen up to 51% more leads and 52% more revenue.

CONSULTATION NO-SHOW RATE

Review weekly and evaluate emerging trends each month.

Analyzing no-show data can help identify trends, implement preventative measures, and optimize appointment scheduling. A high no-show rate can indicate issues with scheduling, communication, or client fit—potentially impacting revenue and workload. Consider a scheduling tool (e.g. Clio Scheduler) to automate bookings.

TIME TO INTAKE COMPLETION

Review monthly in admin performance planning.

Set a 1–2 day benchmark, identify where the process slows (e.g., scheduling, missing form completion deadlines, back-and-forth communication) and optimize based on bottlenecks. Using Clio Grow to automate intake helps firms onboard clients an average of four days faster.

MOST PROFITABLE MATTER TYPES

Review quarterly in finance planning.

Align marketing and intake strategy toward your most profitable case categories.

MATTER TYPE DISTRIBUTION

Review bi-annually in strategy planning.

Use this insight to assess if your firm's matter mix aligns with your strategic goals and revenue targets.

Team Productivity

CASEWORK VOLUME

Review weekly with management.

Redistribute caseloads to balance effort and maintain service standards.

BILLABLE VS. NON-BILLABLE HOURS

Review monthly in 1:1s and performance reviews.

Identify and offload low-value tasks for team members that can be delegated or automated.

REVENUE PER LAWYER

Review monthly in 1:1 meetings with lawyers.

Use this metric for goal setting, evaluating productivity performance, bonus structure discussions, and identifying outliers in productivity who require coaching.

AVERAGE CASE DURATION

Discuss quarterly in legal team reviews.

Set case benchmarks to learn from top performers and fix workflow issues with underperformers whose cases fall behind.

ONLINE PAYMENT ADOPTION RATE

Review monthly in finance planning.

Encourage more online payments by explaining benefits to clients and embedding payment links in invoices. Firms using Clio Payments are paid 15 days faster, and are 2.5x more likely to be paid within 7 days, vs. firms that have manual billing only.

AVERAGE RESPONSE TIME

Review monthly in operations meetings.

Establish internal response time SLAs and use them as a service excellence metric in performance evaluations. If team members consistently fall below targets, provide coaching and retraining. Tools like text messaging and online client portals can help you respond faster and keep clients engaged. On average, 87% of firms using Clio's text messaging respond within an hour, and 56% of those messages get a client reply within five minutes. Messages sent through Clio for Clients see similar results—nearly 90% get a response within an hour, with over half answered in just five minutes.

Reporting Tips:

- Set up and schedule automated reporting in Clio to consistently track key metrics like productivity, realization rates, and task completion—right from your inbox.
- Reference your Firm Dashboard in Clio Manage for a visual snapshot of your firm's real-time performance across utilization, realization, and collection rates. Filter by % on the top right of the graphs to get monthly trends.
- Keep your team members accountable by setting an individual Billable Hours target in their Personal Dashboards in Clio Manage. Encouraging them to regularly check their performance and discuss in weekly check-ins.